

# Matthew Mettler

Ph.D. Candidate in Political Science

University of Illinois Urbana Champaign

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<https://matthewmettler.github.io>

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## EDUCATION

**Ph.D. Political Science**, University of Illinois *Expected 2027*

Dissertation: Fact-Opinion Differentiation Among Citizens: The Role of Partisan Identity, Cognitive Resources, and Media. Committee: Jeffery Mondak (Chair), Damarys Canache, Brian Gaines, and Thomas Rudolph

**M.A. International Relations**, University of South Dakota 2019

**B.S. Political Science**, South Dakota State University 2013

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## RESEARCH INTERESTS

**Political Behavior:** How citizens evaluate political information, distinguish facts from opinions, respond to misinformation, and form political judgments; partisanship, polarization, religion, and voting behavior.

**Political Institutions and Public Policy:** How political institutions, public policies, and elite behavior shape public opinion and political participation; political representation, policy feedback, institutional trust, and democratic accountability.

**Political Methodology:** Survey research, experimental methods, measurement, causal inference, and statistical analysis.

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## PUBLICATIONS

### Book

Hibbing, M., **Mettler, M.**, Mondak, J., & Raynal, I. (forthcoming, 2027). *(Mis)understanding the Other Side: How Americans Explain Opposing Views*. Temple University Press.

### Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

Henderson, E., **Mettler, M.**, Mondak, J., & Peffley, M. (2026). Experiential spillover in public views of police and courts. *Journal of Law and Courts*. [View online](#).

Canache, D., Knoll, N., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. (2025). Indigenous quotas and symbolic representation in Latin America. *Journal of Politics in Latin America*. [View online](#).

McClinton, K., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. (2025). Conceptualizing and measuring structural overlap in the political attitudes and orientations of multidimensional groups. *Social Science Quarterly*, 106(3). [View online](#).

Pagán-Márquez, A., Djupe, P., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. (2024). Was there an enthusiasm gap? Examining support for Donald Trump among evangelicals and nonevangelicals. *Politics & Religion*, 17(3), 410–430. [View online](#).

**Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. (2024). Fact–opinion differentiation. *Harvard Kennedy School Misinformation Review*, 5(2). [View online](#).

### Job Market Paper

**Mettler, M.** Accuracy, Bias, or Noise in Political Judgments? A Compositional Approach to Fact–Opinion Classification.

### Revise and Resubmit

Canache, D., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. Guardrails, Accomplices, or Bystanders? Citizen Response to Undemocratic Elite Cues. *Democratization*.

Canache, D., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. Three Tests of the Political Impact of Individual-Level Variation in the Negativity Bias. *Journal of Experimental Political Science*.

## Under Review

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, Mondak, J., & Strojny, L. There but for Misfortune: The Impact of Economic Information and Misinformation on Voting in the 2024 U.S. Presidential Election. Under review.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. A Targeted Strategy for Improving the Mass Public's Capacity to Identify True and False Political Claims. Under review.

## Working Papers

**Mettler, M.** Nudging Away from Bias: Accuracy Prompts and Partisan Fact–Opinion Classification.

**Mettler, M.** Facts by Association: How Media Cues Shape Political Classification.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. A Multidimensional Approach to Measuring Misinformation Response Tendencies.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. Creating Measures of Retrospective Perceptions beyond Economic Indicators.

Lim, Y., & **Mettler, M.** Moral Tradeoffs in Candidate Choice: When Do Evangelical Voters Excuse Misconduct?

## Public Scholarship and Media Engagement

Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Wilson, R. F. (2023). Eviction expectations in the aftermath of the pandemic moratoria. *University of Illinois College of Law Legal Studies Research Paper* (No. 24-06).

Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Wilson, R. F. (2023). Texas's movement to online court is sensible, but more study should follow. *Voice for the Defense*, 20–22.

Gaines, B., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Fretwell-Wilson, R. (2022). Race and eviction during the pandemic. *Institute of Government and Public Affairs—Policy Spotlight*.

Gaines, B., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Fretwell-Wilson, R. (2022). Courts and the housing market. *News-Gazette*.

Gaines, B., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, Fretwell-Wilson, R., & Miller, A. (2022). The impact of COVID-19 on state court proceedings: Five key findings. *Institute of Government and Public Affairs—Policy Spotlight*.

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## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Canache, D., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. (2026). The political impact of individual-level variation in the negativity bias. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the International Society of Political Psychology, Newcastle.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. (2026). Economic realities, partisan fictions: Facts, perceptions, and partisan bias in economic voting. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago.

Henderson, E., **Mettler, M.**, Mondak, J., & Peffley, M. (2025). Experiential spillover in public views of police and courts. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the American Political Science Association, Vancouver, British Columbia, Canada.

Canache, D., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. (2025). Elite cues can induce the erosion of democratic support: Evidence from two U.S. surveys. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the International Society of Political Psychology, Prague.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. (2025). Fostering political lie detection. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. (2025). Measuring and modeling misinformation: A strategy for assessing the relative prevalence of partisan and residual error. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago.

Lim, Y., & **Mettler, M.** (2025). When to tolerate immorality by elected officials and when not to. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago.

Canache, D., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. (2025). Elite cues and Americans' support for authoritarian world leaders. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Southern Political Science Association, San Juan.

Canache, D., Knoll, N., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. (2024). Indigenous quotas and perceived representation in Latin America. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the European Political Science Association, Cologne, Germany.

Gaines, B., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Fretwell-Wilson, R. (2022). Race and eviction during the pandemic. Paper presented at the Race and Social Justice Symposium, University of Illinois.

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## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

### Instructor of Record

|                                   |             |
|-----------------------------------|-------------|
| The U.S. Supreme Court            | Summer 2026 |
| Politics and the Media            | Fall 2025   |
| Introduction to American Politics | Spring 2025 |
| Introduction to Politics          | Fall 2024   |

### Teaching Assistant

|                                         |             |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------|
| State Government in the United States   | Fall 2026   |
| Introduction to International Relations | Spring 2026 |
| Strategic International Relations       | Spring 2024 |
| Junior Honors Thesis                    | Fall 2023   |
| Introduction to Political Behavior      | Fall 2023   |

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## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

### Research Assistant

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| Institute of Government and Public Affairs (IGPA)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 2021–2022 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Collaborated with a team of scholars investigating the effects of COVID-19 on state court systems.</li><li>• Prepared policy reports for publication through IGPA's Access to Justice initiative.</li><li>• Conducted in-depth interviews with court officials for policy research projects.</li></ul> |           |

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## AWARDS

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| Teachers Ranked as Excellent by Their Students, University of Illinois | 2026 |
| Teachers Ranked as Excellent by Their Students, University of Illinois | 2025 |

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## FELLOWSHIPS & GRANTS

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| Dissertation Completion Fellowship (\$12,000), University of Illinois | 2026 |
| MPSA Travel Grant, Department of Political Science                    | 2026 |

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| Summer Dissertation Fellowship (\$3,000), Department of Political Science | 2025 |
| MPSA Travel Grant, Department of Political Science                        | 2025 |

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## SERVICE & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

### Journal Reviewer

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| <i>Harvard Kennedy School Misinformation Review</i> | 2026 |
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### Methods Instructor

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| Political Science Math Camp—Probability and R Programming       | 2025 |
| Political Science Math Camp—Probability and R Programming       | 2024 |
| Political Science Math Camp—Linear Regression and R Programming | 2023 |

### Committee Service

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|---------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Faculty Search Committee, Graduate Representative | 2024      |
| Political Science Math Camp Committee             | 2023-2025 |

### Undergraduate Senior Thesis Advisor

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| <b>Josh Ellison</b>                                                                           | 2026 |
| <i>Challenging the Partisan Voter: A Two-Dimensional Model of Vote Choice beyond Ideology</i> |      |
| <b>Nathan Knoll</b>                                                                           | 2025 |
| <i>Effects of Legislative Gender Quotas on Political Efficacy</i>                             |      |
| <b>Vindhya Kalipi</b>                                                                         | 2024 |
| <i>I'm Just a Bill: The Impact of Civic Education on Democratic Engagement</i>                |      |

### Public Engagement

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|------------------------------------------------|------|
| <i>The 21st Show</i> , Illinois Public Media   | 2024 |
| Interviews with WTAX, Illinois statewide radio | 2023 |
| WCIA-TV, Champaign, Illinois                   | 2023 |
| <i>CBS Chicago Morning Show</i>                | 2023 |

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## **PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS**

American Political Science Association (APSA)

International Society of Political Psychology (ISPP)

Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)